



UHLB2122

PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION SKILLS 1

SECTION 55

GROUP 2A

WRITING REPORT:

**TITLE : THE ROLE OF EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES IN CULTIVATING
ESSENTIAL SOFT SKILLS AMONG STUDENTS**

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SECTION 55

1.0 INTRODUCTION

Nowadays, the competition for jobs is becoming increasingly fierce. Many companies clearly state that the graduates they want not only have solid professional skills but also possess good communication skills, the ability to lead a team, and the ability to cooperate. These soft skills are all very important for collaborating with others and are the motivational characteristics to becoming career-ready in today's workplace. However, traditional education fails to cultivate these multidimensional skills due to passive learning models (Munadi et al., 2021). Instead, extracurricular activities play a more significant role, for instance, having students participate in campus activities as volunteers to serve others or organizing campus evening parties to enable students to truly learn teamwork and problem-solving skills. It is believed that these experiences are particularly helpful for personal growth and future careers. This report aims to analyze how participation in extracurricular activities promotes the development of students' soft skills and deeply explores the institutional support system for this transformation process.

2.0 ACTIVE PARTICIPATION IN EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

How much students can learn from extracurricular activities depends on how deeply they engage in them. Simply participating in clubs such as debate teams, art groups, sports teams, volunteer activities like community clean-ups, tutoring others, or taking part in campus competitions is far from enough. To truly gain something, one must take the initiative and forge ahead by completing the assigned tasks to the end and collaborating closely with students from different backgrounds. For example, students organizing an event or resolving conflicts within the team. This will only encourage students to apply those soft skills that are not taught in textbooks in a practical way (Ibrahim et al., 2021). This continuous commitment is the key to laying a solid foundation. It not only helps students build a foundation for future job hunting, such as the stories you tell the interviewers, but also makes them be more confident and better at dealing with different people. In summary, it is through repeated experiences of setbacks that students' communication and adaptability skills can be tested.

3.0 POSITIVE EFFECTS 1: SOFT SKILLS DEVELOPMENT-COMMUNICATION, TEAMWORK, LEADERSHIP

Extracurricular learning is vital for developing core professional competencies such as structured communication, collaboration, and leadership. Through immersive community problem-solving like committee decisions or cross-cultural dialogues, students can refine job-market valued skills. Students also can participate in specific roles such as leading workshops or mediating conflicts to enhance their leadership effectiveness, teamwork, and interpersonal dynamics. According to Peng (2023), students who took part in more extracurricular activities demonstrate stronger abilities in thinking interpretation, leadership execution, and team cohesion building, which constitute the core elements of career preparation. Likewise, Ibrahim et al. (2021) suggested that students participate in embodied forms such as cross-club cooperation is significantly superior to pure theoretical teaching in terms of communication and leadership development. Furthermore, Bhullar and Singh (2021) point out that extracurricular involvement leads to the development of teamwork and leadership, all of which are integral components of career readiness.

4.0 POSITIVE EFFECTS 2: SOFT SKILLS DEVELOPMENT-ADAPTABILITY, EMOTIONAL MATURITY, CONFIDENCE

Active participation in extracurricular activities not only boosts employability but it also nurtures soft skills such as adaptability, emotional maturity, and self-confidence that contribute to students' personal growth. When students participate in initiatives such as charity drives or skill-sharing workshops, they face challenges, take on responsibilities, and interact with different perspectives, which fosters their adaptability as they learn to modify their strategies and communication approaches (Bhullar & Singh, 2021). Emotional maturity grows through high-stakes scenarios, like mediating disputes or recovering from project failures, which teach students to manage frustration, empathy, and resilience (Munadi et al., 2021). Self-confidence blooms as ideas drive real outcomes, from successful fundraisers to consistent contributions, with Peng (2023) explaining this "action-achievement" cycle boosts self-belief for handling workplace, academic and interpersonal pressures. These benefits differ from the technical and cognitive skills learned in the classroom, highlighting the value of well-rounded and character-focused individuals shaped through extracurricular activities.

5.0 POTENTIAL DRAWBACK OF EXTRACURRICULAR PARTICIPATION

Some people believe that too many extracurricular activities might distract students from their studies and prevent them from concentrating on their schoolwork. Moreover, if the activities are not properly arranged, they won't be able to provide students with meaningful learning experiences. Instead, poorly managed extracurricular activities might have a negative impact on students. To address these issues, institutions need to carefully design the extracurricular activities by allocating appropriate time, providing strong support, and offering sufficient resources (Lim & Mandrinos, 2020).

6.0 SOLUTION: THE ROLE OF INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT IN ENHANCING SKILL DEVELOPMENT

Extracurricular activities build valuable skills, but institutional support boosts their success. Timetabled and promoted programs help students engage meaningfully. When institutions support initiatives with sufficient resources and recognition, students are motivated to maximize these opportunities. Lim and Mandrinos (2020) highlighted that high education institutions can strengthen career readiness among students by organizing activities that develop soft and technical skills, which aligns with the idea that institutional support amplifies extracurricular impact. Planning and investment expand access and ensure quality, shaping skill development. Thus, institutional support strengthens the link between extracurriculars and soft-skill learning, with the research bridging theoretical benefits and practical career readiness, reinforcing the idea that support boosting success and skill-building.

7.0 CONCLUSION

This report has demonstrated that active participation in extracurricular activities plays a vital role in creating desired soft skills in university students like communication, leadership, collaboration, confidence, and maturity. These are crucial for both workplace readiness and individual development. The gains of such participation are also amplified where universities provide cohesive support and facilities. To further these findings, institutions need to actively encourage students to engage, increase access to a range of extracurricular activities, and formally reward students' achievements in soft skills. Future research could include exploring the integration of soft skill training into curricula and the long - term career advantage of taking part in extracurricular activities. As a result, higher education can continue developing graduates that are not only successful in academics but also socially skilled and workplace-ready individuals.

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1.0 Introduction

Newspapers, the competition for jobs is becoming increasingly fierce. Many companies clearly state that the graduates they want not only have solid professional skills but also possess good communication skills, the ability to lead a team, and the ability to cooperate. These soft skills are all very important for collaborating with others and are the motivational characteristics to becoming career goals as today's workplace. However, traditional